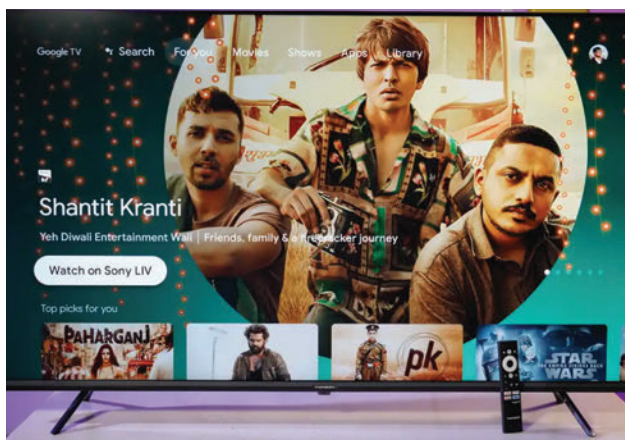
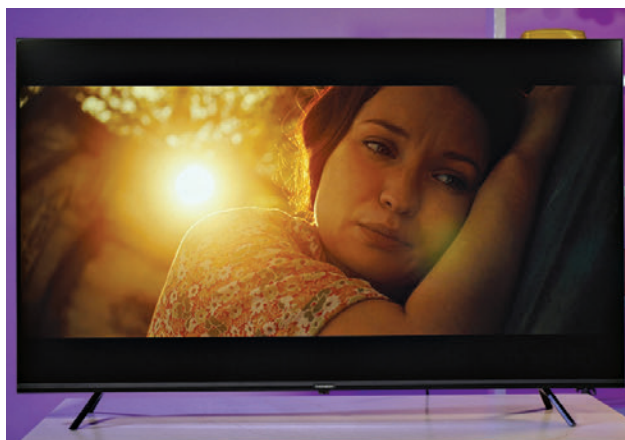




in this price segment. The blacks are noticeably raised and the TV struggles to deliver impactful HDR highlights. Even subtle details like shadows on faces get clipped.

During our perceptual testing, we noticed that the skin tones were natural in both HDR10 and SDR content. In Dolby Vision content, we noticed a slight red tint on fair skin tones.

The colour of the grass and sky felt accurate in both SDR and HDR content.

Overall, the picture quality exceeded our expectations. The panel is quite good at reproducing colours accurately, but expectedly falls short when it comes to dynamic range in luminance.

Note: The first Thomson OP MAX 4K LED TV we received had some glaring issues with picture quality in Dolby Vision and with colour performance in SDR/HDR. Thomson then replaced our review unit with a new model. The findings mentioned above pertain to the updated unit.

GAMING AND AUDIO

The TV lacks gamer-centric features and a dedicated game mode. However, for casual gamers, the response time with consoles should suffice. In our testing with the PS5, gameplay was generally smooth. The HDR experience, however, is not particularly impactful in this case.

The Dolby Atmos audio on the TV is underwhelming, which prompted us to switch it off for improved dialogue clarity. The Audio gets fairly loud but doesn't feel well-balanced. For an immersive audio experience, you will need to invest in a soundbar.

VERDICT

The Thomson OP MAX 4K LED Smart Google TV (2023) review is a feature-rich 4K HDR TV that punches above its weight. Its IPS LCD panel delivers excellent colour accuracy and should be great for viewing content in well-lit rooms. The dynamic range and

contrast you get from the IPS panel are not enough for an impactful HDR experience, but that's perhaps to be expected of all TVs in the affordable price segment. If you are into gaming, the TCL T6G in this segment should serve you better.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Model number: 550PMAXGT9030 | Display Panel Size: 55-inch | Display Panel Type: LED LCD (IPS LCD) | Display Panel Resolution: 3840 x 2160 - 4K UHD | Display Refresh Rate: 60Hz | Supported HDR Formats: Dolby Vision, HDR10+, HDR10, HLG | Speakers: 40W | Audio formats: Supports Dolby Atmos and DTS TruSurround | Software: Google TV (Android TV 11) | HDMI Ports: 3x HDMI (one with ARC) | Other connectivity options: 2 USB 2.0 ports, Dual Band Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, Ethernet, AV Input, Digital Audio, Antenna | Processor: Quad Core Cortex A53, Mali G52 | Built-in RAM and storage: 2GB + 16GB

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